BLOODS, MARKERS & LIFESTYLE

TRT Monitoring & Optimisation

What we monitor, what your results mean, and the lifestyle levers we control together. Your dose and any medication are prescribed and adjusted only by your clinician, never guessed.

01 The blood panel: hormones

Bloods come first. They turn guesswork into evidence. This is what we look at and why.

MARKER	WHY IT MATTERS	TYPICAL RANGE
Total testosterone	Primary marker. Confirms you're in a genuine replacement range	**8.6–29 nmol/L**
Free testosterone	The active, unbound fraction actually available to your tissues	**0.20–0.62 nmol/L**
SHBG	Binds testosterone and drives how much free T you have	**18–54 nmol/L**
Oestradiol (E2)	Converts from testosterone. We want it balanced, not zero	**40–160 pmol/L**
LH & FSH	Pituitary signals; show your natural production status	**Suppressed on TRT**
BLOOD & METABOLIC		
Haematocrit	Red-cell thickness. The key TRT safety marker	**< 0.52**
HbA1c / glucose	Blood-sugar control and metabolic health	**< 42 mmol/mol**

RANGES VARY

Reference ranges are typical adult-male values and vary between laboratories. "Optimal" is individual and is interpreted alongside your full results by your prescribing clinician.

01B The blood panel: lipids, liver, kidney & prostate

MARKER	WHY IT MATTERS	TYPICAL RANGE
LIPIDS		
Total cholesterol	Overall cardiovascular risk picture	**< 5.0 mmol/L**
LDL	"Lower-is-better" cholesterol	**< 3.0 mmol/L**
HDL	Protective cholesterol	**> 1.0 mmol/L**
Triglycerides	Blood fats, strongly diet-driven	**< 1.7 mmol/L**
LIVER, KIDNEY & PROSTATE		
ALT / AST / GGT	Liver function	**ALT < 50 U/L**
eGFR / creatinine	Kidney function	**eGFR > 90**
PSA	Prostate baseline + monitoring (age-dependent)	**< 2.5–4.0 µg/L**
Blood pressure	TRT can raise it. Tracked at every check-in	**< 130/80**

02 Testing cadence

BASELINE · BEFORE ANY CHANGE	Full panel above, so every decision is made against your real starting numbers.
6–8 WEEKS · FIRST REVIEW	Re-test the key markers to see how your body is responding and refine the approach.
QUARTERLY · ONGOING	Hormones plus the TRT safety markers (haematocrit, blood pressure) once you're settled.
ANNUAL · FULL PANEL	Complete re-test of everything, including lipids, metabolic and prostate markers.

03 Wellbeing & symptom tracking

Numbers only tell half the story. How you feel is data too. We track these week to week so trends show up early:

- ☐ Energy & drive
- ☐ Libido
- ☐ Mood & wellbeing
- ☐ Sleep quality
- ☐ Training performance
- ☐ Recovery between sessions
- ☐ Motivation & focus
- ☐ Morning readiness

04 The lifestyle pillars

These are the levers we control directly, and they decide how well any protocol actually works.

Training

Structured, progressive resistance work programmed to your goal and recovery.

Nutrition

Calories and protein anchored to your fat-loss target, adjusted from real results.

Recovery & sleep

8 hours protected. The single biggest multiplier on how you respond.

Stress & steps

Daily movement and stress management to support hormones and metabolic health.

05 When to contact your clinician or GP

SPEAK TO YOUR CLINICIAN PROMPTLY IF YOU EXPERIENCE

Chest pain or shortness of breath, persistent very high blood pressure, severe headaches, unusual swelling or calf pain, vision changes, or any symptom that feels significantly off. This document does not replace medical care.

Any questions on the framework, just ask. We'll go through your bloods together at every review.

All the best,

Callum

WANT THIS MANAGED PROPERLY?

Bloods read, training built, everything tracked

The free discovery call is 20 minutes, no pressure. We look at where you are and whether coaching around your protocol makes sense. **callumbcoaching.co.uk/book**